connection to the LeBlanc family. Soldiers might arrive tonight to question them. Rose had to warn them. She wasn't worried about Virginie, but Paulette, out of fear, might reveal something she'd overheard, putting them all at risk.

Reaching the end of the tunnel, Rose rushed into the cave. Every minute was precious. She crept up the stairs and lifted the hatch door. She listened for a few seconds before deciding no one was there, and entered the *chai*, closing the door and replacing the rug and furniture to hide it.

Outside, the night was still and quiet. The full moon shone on the courtyard, casting eerie shadows over the farmhouse. From the kitchen, she hurried to her room, hiding her clothes at the bottom of the laundry hamper and putting on pajamas. She pulled back the sheets on her bed and ruffled the pillow before making her way to Paulette's room.

Moonlight shone in from the window, falling over the young girl's face. She was in such a peaceful sleep that Rose didn't want to wake her, but if her instincts were correct, then her sleep would soon be disturbed by loud knocking and shouting voices. There was no way to escape the impending danger.

"Paulette, wake up, it's Rose."

She turned to her side and opened her eyes. "Rose?"

"I need you to do something very important for me. Listen."

Paulette sat up on one elbow and rubbed her eyes. "Yes."

"Tonight, some men from the police will knock on the door. They will ask you questions. You must tell them only what I tell you. Do you understand?"

Rose made Paulette repeat it two times, then slipped into the bed with her, covering them both with the sheet. Rose closed her eyes, wishing she could fall asleep, but every fiber in her body was pounding like a wild animal waiting for the predator to pounce out of the deep blackness. Eventually, sleep must have overtaken her because she awoke to pounding on the door. She got up, went to the corridor, and saw Virginie opening the door.

"Is Rose Cotillard here?" a German officer demanded, pushing the door aside and entering the house.

"What do you want with Rose?" Virginie asked.

"Is she here?"